including Gaza and the West Bank, from the Arabs. To his left was Yasser Arafat, mastermind of a long terrorist war against Israel. Once bitter enemies, they were risking their political lives on an agreement giving Palestinians self-rule in the Gaza Strip and part of the West Bank in return for official recognition of the Jewish state.

What was agreed?

The Israeli and Palestinian leaders agreed that:

- Israeli troops would be withdrawn from Gaza and the city of Jericho (see the map on page 11) on the West Bank. After that, they would be withdrawn from other parts, but not all, of the West Bank. For instance, Israeli troops would *not* be withdrawn from their military bases, from Jewish settlements or from Jerusalem.
- Elections would be held for a **Palestinian Authority** (PA) to run the West Bank and Gaza for five years.
- During these five years a final settlement would be discussed.

Key term
Palestinian Authority
A Palestinian 'government', with limited authority, in the West Bank and Gaza.

The Oslo Accord was not really a peace treaty. It established a timetable for Palestinian self-government but it postponed any final settlement. The most difficult questions were to be settled over the next five years. (These are explained on page 96.) Nevertheless, it was a historic breakthrough because, after 46 years, the two sides had accepted the principle of partition which the UN had first proposed in 1947. Within a year, Israeli troops were withdrawn from Gaza and Jericho, as agreed. In July 1994, Yasser Arafat received a hero's welcome when he arrived in Gaza. It was the first time he had set foot on Palestinian soil for 27 years.

Oslo II Accord 1995

In 1995 a second Israeli–Palestinian agreement was signed. It became known as the Oslo II Accord. It was agreed that:

- elections to the Palestinian Authority would finally be held
- Israeli forces would withdraw from major Palestinian towns
- Palestinian prisoners would be released from Israeli jails.

When elections were held for the PA, the PLO won the majority of seats and Arafat was later elected President of the Palestinian Authority.

Israel–Jordan peace treaty 1994

Key date
Israel–Jordan peace treaty: 1994

In the wake of the Israeli–Palestinian agreement of 1993, Jordan signed a peace treaty with Israel in which the two sides settled their dispute over their borders. More importantly, Jordan became the second Arab state (after Egypt in 1978) to recognise the state of Israel and to open up trade and other links. Relations between Israel and Syria, however, remained very bitter and no agreement was reached on the return of the Golan Heights (see page 52) to Syria.